

Kirill Kazakov

Senior Platform & DevOps Engineer — Web3 / DeFi Infrastructure

Co-author of "Kubernetes Cookbook" · CKA · AWS SAA · GCP Professional Cloud Architect · OSS maintainer · 500+ engineers mentored

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Summary

Senior Platform & DevOps Engineer with 9+ years in Kubernetes, AWS, Terraform, and CI/CD - and hands-on Web3 leadership as part-time CTO of [Aura X Capital](#), a DeFi vault platform on TON (EVM in progress) serving 350,000+ users. Architected infrastructure behind 1.2B+ user/on-chain transactions; built greenfield AWS/EKS/GitOps stack and a custom CDN ([cdnn.cloud](#)) to keep the platform reachable across regions. Enterprise track record includes a full AWS migration for a crypto gaming & sportsbook client and CI/CD platform for 100+ FinTech microservices (via GlobalDots). I understand both sides: protocol-level products (vaults, DEX, LP) and the infrastructure that keeps them live 24/7.

Key achievements:

- Architected infrastructure for 1.2B+ user/on-chain transactions; DeFi platform scale 350k+ users, 60k MAU, 7.5k DAU (Aura X Capital)
 - Designed and shipped custom CDN ([cdnn.cloud](#)) to bypass regional blockages; integrated with main platform
 - Full AWS migration for a crypto gaming & sportsbook platform - Terraform IaC, phased cutover CI/CD -> infra -> data -> traffic (via GlobalDots)
 - Built self-service CI/CD platform for 100+ microservices; node warm-up 3h->seconds for 1000+ pods on EKS - featured in [Learn Kubernetes Weekly #116](#)
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Technical Skills

Category	Skills
Web3 / DeFi	TON ecosystem (EVM in progress), DeFi vaults & concentrated liquidity (V3), DEX/LP products, high-throughput on-chain transaction infrastructure, CDN engineering for censorship resilience
Kubernetes & Platform	Kubernetes, EKS, GKE, Helm, Karpenter, KEDA, ArgoCD, Argo Events, Argo Workflows, Gateway API
Cloud (AWS)	AWS (official AWS Partner track) - SoW assessment, Well-Architected reviews, MORA, MODA; architecture & migration design for clients; broad service portfolio (EKS, ECR, ECS, RDS Aurora, ElastiCache, event-driven, multi-client production)
Cloud (other)	GCP; Cloudflare (DNS, Workers, Pages, Zero Trust, IaC)

Category	Skills
IaC & GitOps	Terraform, Terragrunt, GitOps, FluxCD
CI/CD	GitHub Actions, Jenkins, GitLab CI - reusable pipelines, service catalog integration
Reliability (SRE)	SLO/SLI design, incident response, post-mortems, 4 Golden Signals, zero-downtime rollouts (PDB)
Observability	Grafana, Prometheus, Loki, OpenTelemetry, Datadog
Security	RBAC, OAuth, Network Policies, Zero Trust, CIS Benchmark
Languages & Tools	Python (automation, scripts), Bash, Docker, Linux, Git

Professional Experience

Chief Technology Officer (CTO) - part-time

Aura X Capital | Jul 2024 - present (*parallel to GlobalDots through Feb 2026*)

Algorithmic DeFi vault platform on TON (EVM in progress): non-custodial vaults for concentrated liquidity (V3) with ML-driven rebalancing and oracle-mediated execution. 350,000+ users; backed by Cryptorg.io, yard[hub], Ston.fi.

- **Web3 platform at scale** - Architected infrastructure for 1.2B+ user/on-chain transactions; platform scale 60k MAU, 7.5k DAU, +10% WoW growth; products: RAUM Launchdrop, Omni DEX, Dynamic LP (TON/USDT)
- **Greenfield AWS infrastructure** - EKS, Terraform, FluxCD/GitOps from scratch; Grafana (GitHub SSO), Prometheus, Loki; reusable GitHub Actions CI/CD for ~20 services - single baseline for main and child projects
- **Custom CDN (cdn.cloud)** - Designed, implemented, and deployed custom CDN to bypass regional blockages; integrated with main platform - critical availability layer for a global crypto audience
- **Engineering team build-out** - Recruited and onboarded developers; established code review, CI/CD, and observability practices from day one; partnered with CEO on tech strategy and infra budget

Senior DevOps Engineer (DevOps as a Service)

GlobalDots | Apr 2022 - Feb 2026

Platform and infra delivery for 6 enterprise clients (FinTech, Crypto/gaming, AI Security, Public sector).

- **Crypto gaming & sportsbook platform migration** - Full DigitalOcean -> AWS migration per SoW: Terraform IaC, ECS, RDS Aurora, ElastiCache, S3; phased cutover CI/CD -> infrastructure -> data -> traffic with zero product downtime (client name not disclosed per agreement)
- **Self-service CI/CD platform** - Built reusable GitHub Actions workflows and bash libraries for Justt, FinTech (100+ microservices); standardized delivery across repos

- **Argo family integration** - ArgoCD (GitOps), Argo Events, Argo Workflows as unified platform for 100+ microservices at Justt; authored [GlobalDots ArgoCD troubleshooting eBook](#) (10k+ reach)
- **Node warm-up for EKS** - Pod startup from 3h->seconds for 1000+ pods with 3GB images (Justt); [published solution](#) featured in Learn Kubernetes Weekly #116
- **KEDA + Karpenter FinOps** - KEDA autoscaling on message queue metrics (infra costs -5%); Karpenter bin packing and spot/on-demand mix (Justt; enterprise AI Security client)
- **Zero Trust IaC** - Cloudflare setup, IaC + CI/CD for zero-trust architecture, sub-organizational access separation for a public-sector government client

Clients: Justt (FinTech); other client names not disclosed per agreement - Crypto/gaming, AI Security, API Security, Public sector

Lead DevOps Engineer

Simplinic GmbH (IoT healthcare) | Aug 2019 - 2022

IoT platform for hospitals (10k+ assets, 15 hospitals). Key cases:

- **Terraform self-service** - Custom Terraform modules for multi-env deployment; company-wide Terraform registry (S3 + gzip modules, semantic versioning)
- **4 Golden Signals observability** - Dashboards per environment in Grafana (Google SRE model); reduced time to find issues
- **Cost optimization** - GCP preemptible nodes for dev/stage (costs -10%); PDB for zero-downtime rollouts
- **Security incident response** - Remote IoT device malware detection, diagnostics, and remediation without on-site access

DevOps Engineer

LiveSystem (WebRTC streaming) | Apr 2017 - 2019

Sole DevOps in a one-pizza startup. CI/CD from scratch (Jenkins, TTM -90%); IaC (Ansible, provisioning 3 days->3 hours); monitoring (Zabbix, ELK). Support 20h/week->1h.

Key Deliverables

- **DeFi platform infrastructure** - EKS + Terraform + FluxCD/GitOps baseline behind 1.2B+ transactions and 350k+ users; observability and CI/CD for ~20 services (Aura X Capital)
 - **CDNN (cdn.cloud)** - Custom CDN for censorship resilience; designed, deployed, integrated with main platform
 - **Crypto gaming & sportsbook AWS migration** - Terraform IaC, ECS, RDS Aurora, ElastiCache; phased zero-downtime cutover (via GlobalDots)
 - **Argo-based self-service platform** - ArgoCD + Argo Events + Argo Workflows for 100+ microservices; GitOps, event-driven pipelines (Justt, FinTech)
 - **Gateway API Helm Charts** - Open-source K8s Gateway API charts on [Artifact Hub](#) (maintainer)
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Certifications

- Google Cloud Professional Cloud Architect (2025, valid through 2027)
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate (2022/2025, valid through 2028)
- Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) (2021, CNCF/Linux Foundation)

- GitOps Fundamentals (2022, Codefresh)
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Education & Mentoring

- **OTUS** - Instructor (Kubernetes Platform + DevOps Practices), 2021-2025. 500+ students.
 - **SkillFactory** - DevOps Engineer Course author, 2021.
 - **Hackathon Judge:** Digital Breakthrough, IT INNOHACK, Globee Awards, MLH (12+ events).
 - **CI/CD workshops** - GitHub Actions workshops at AGORA HACK and IT_ONE DevOps Champion.
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Thought Leadership

- **[Kubernetes Cookbook](#)** (2024) - Co-authored 171pp, ISBN, Amazon. Technical Reviewer - "Cracking the Kubernetes Interview" (Packt, 2025).
 - **30+ publications** (100k+ total reads) - [K8s Scheduler internals](#) (Habr, 20k+), [K8s security & RBAC hardening](#) (DZone), DNS observability postmortem (HackerNoon), Production Readiness framework (adopted by VP Deutsche Bank).
 - **Conference speaker** - DevOps 2021 (Pulumi vs Terraform, ~400 attendees); OTUS CONF 2024 (Gateway API vs Ingress); FaangTalk podcasts (K8s, Chaos Engineering).
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Education

Saint Petersburg State University - Specialist Degree (5-year, equiv. MSc), Computer Software and Dataware, 2005-2010

Additional

- **Languages:** English (B2+, professional working proficiency), Russian (native)
- **Work setup:** Remote (UTC+3, overlap with EU hours); open to relocation worldwide (EU, Asia, US, and other regions)
- **Interests:** DeFi infrastructure, platform engineering, developer experience, open source, technical writing, mentoring